Cummins College of Engineering for Woman, Nagpur



Department of Computer Engineering

Semester third

ODD SEM [2026 – 2027]

Course: Entrepreneurship and Startups

From Blocks to Billions: The Notch Story

[CO Individual Activity]

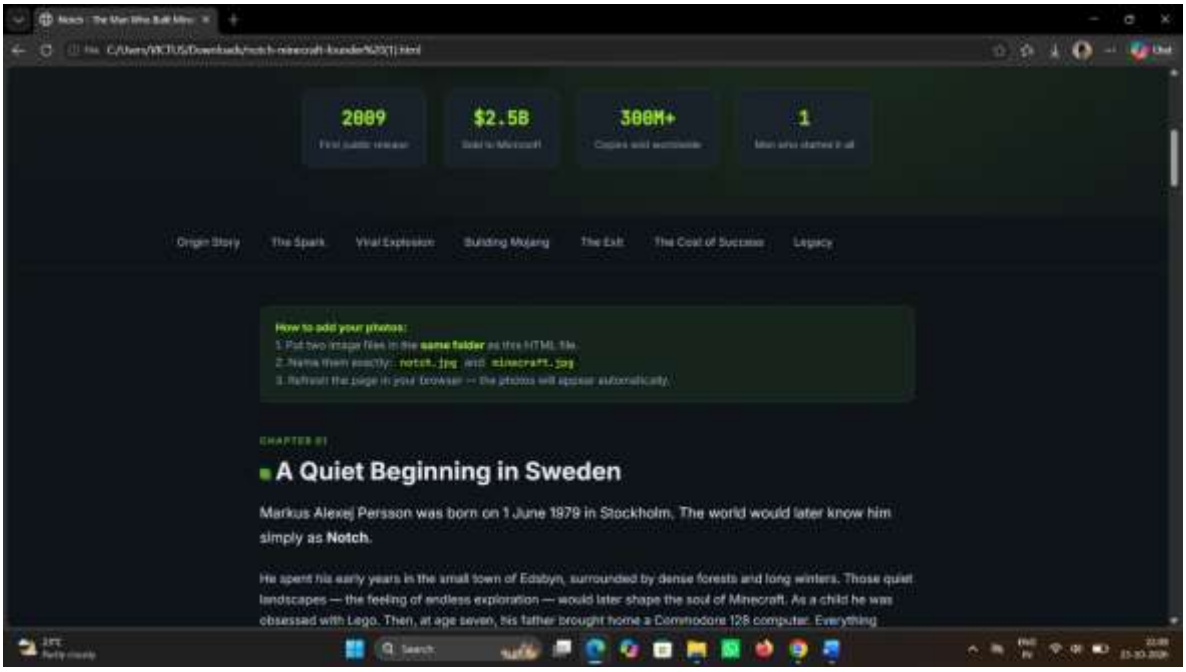
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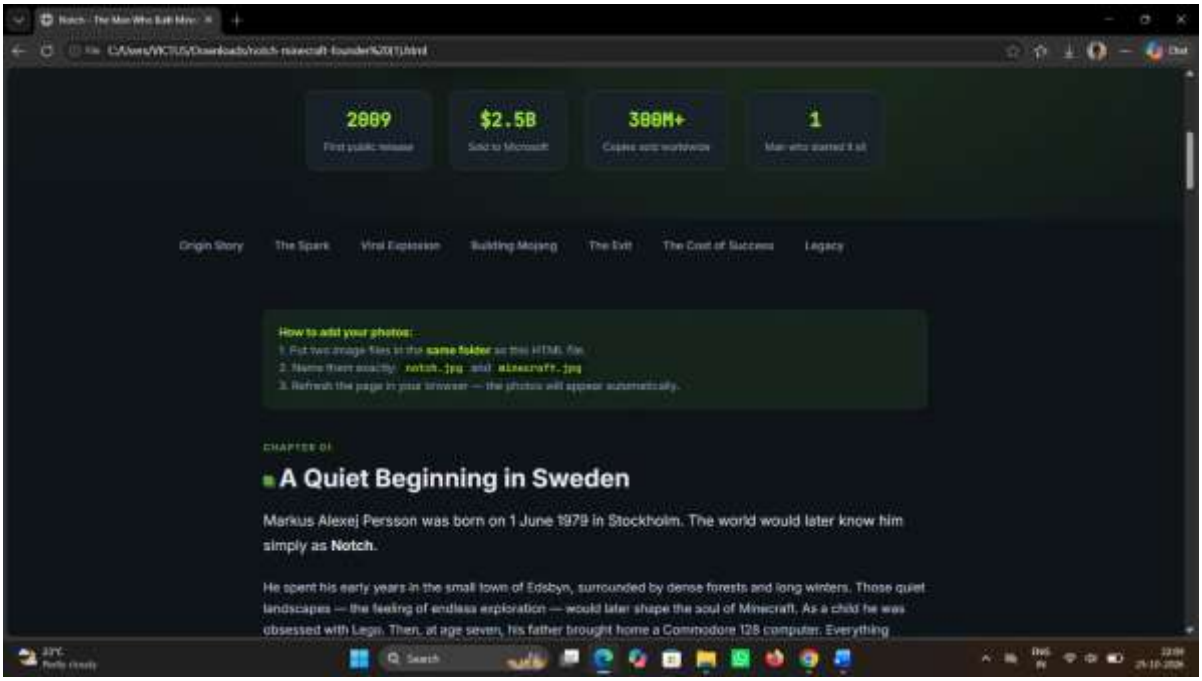
Amisha Patil [3BCE76]

Date: 26 / 10 / 2026

Website link: https://amisha306.github.io/notch-minecraft-story/


THE UNLIKELY BILLIONAIRE BUILDER
Notch
Markus Persson · Creator of Minecraft
From a self-taught Swedish programmer working nights on a side project to the creator of the best-selling video game in history.
2009
$2.5B
300M+
1


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300M+
1
Origin Story
The Spark
Viral Explosion
Building Mojang
The Exit
The Cost of Success
Legacy
How to add your photos:
1. Put two image files in the same folder as this HTML file.
2. Name them exactly: notch.jpg and minecraft.jpg
3. Refresh the page in your browser — the photos will appear automatically.
A Quiet Beginning in Sweden
Markus Alexej Persson was born on 1 June 1979 in Stockholm. The world would later know him simply as Notch.
He spent his early years in the small town of Edsbyn, surrounded by dense forests and long winters. Those quiet landscapes — the feeling of endless exploration — would later shape the soul of Minecraft. As a child he was obsessed with Lego. Then, at age seven, his father brought home a Commodore 128 computer. Everything


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By eight years old he was already writing programs. He created a text adventure game. He reverse-engineered *Doom* — an achievement he still ranks second only to inventing Minecraft. He never finished high school. He didn't need to. Code was already speaking louder than any classroom.

Edsbyn Forests

The snowy woods of his childhood became the blueprint for open-world freedom.

Lego Obsession

Hours spent building taught him the joy of creation without instructions.

Commodore 128

The machine that turned a curious kid into a lifelong programmer.

CHAPTER 02

The Spark That Became Minecraft

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CHAPTER 02

The Spark That Became Minecraft

In early 2009, while working a regular programming job, Markus started a personal side project. He expected it to last six to twelve months and maybe fund the next game.

Inspired by *Infiniminer*, *Dwarf Fortress*, and the pure sandbox joy of building, he wanted something simple: a world made of blocks where players could dig, place, survive, and create without being told what to do. The graphics were deliberately crude — not because he couldn't do better, but because he wanted to ship fast and iterate.

He posted the first version on the indie forum TIGSource in May 2009. No marketing. No publisher. No big studio. Just a download link and a quiet hope.

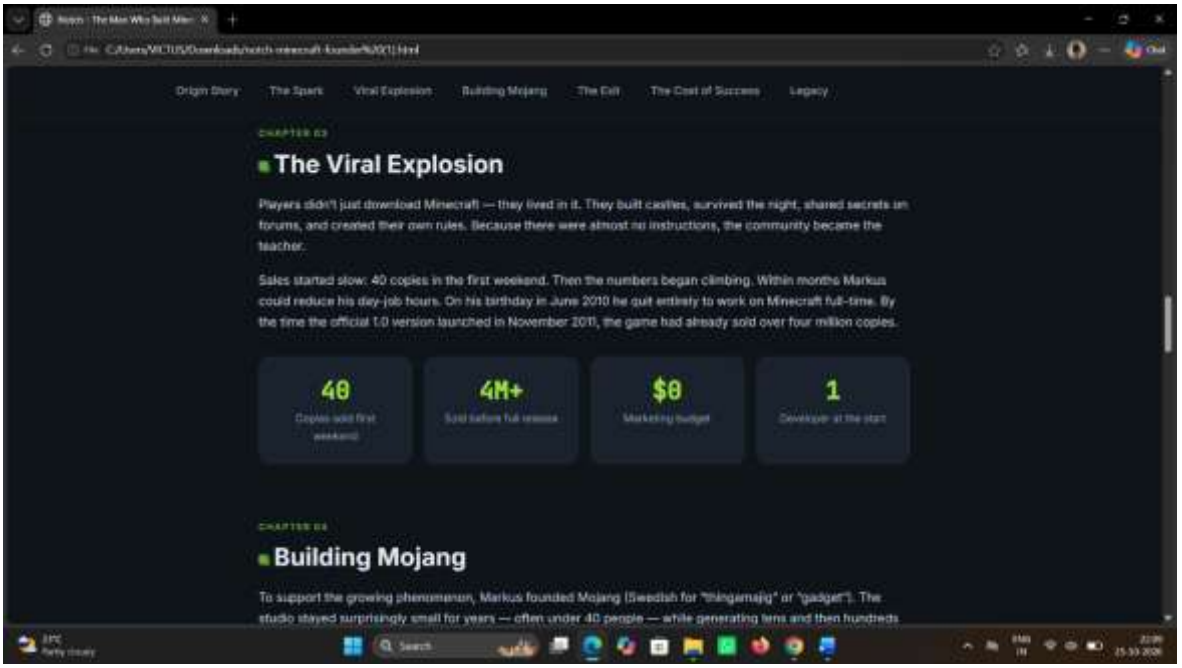


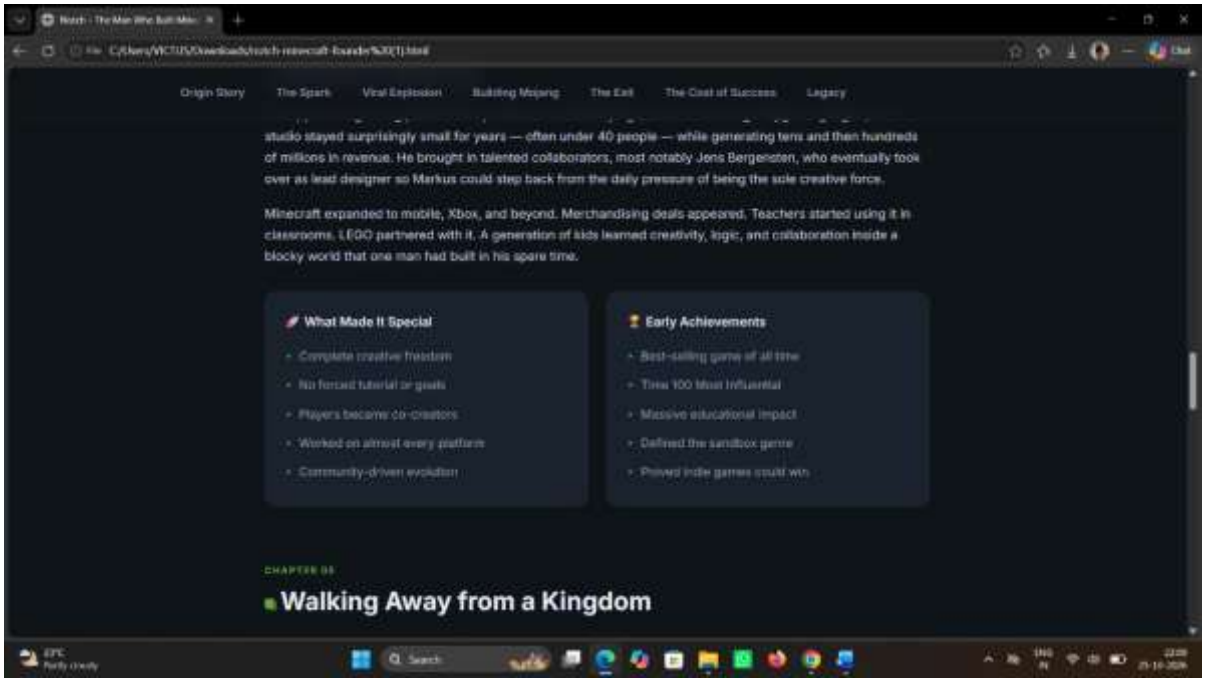
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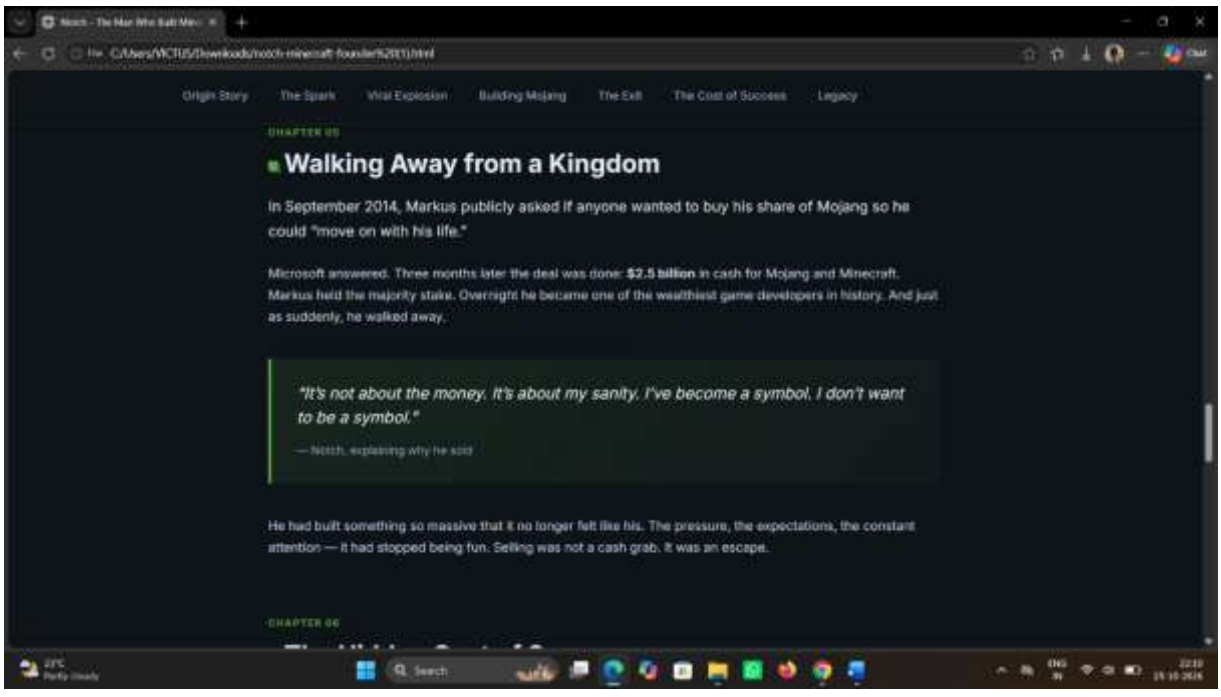
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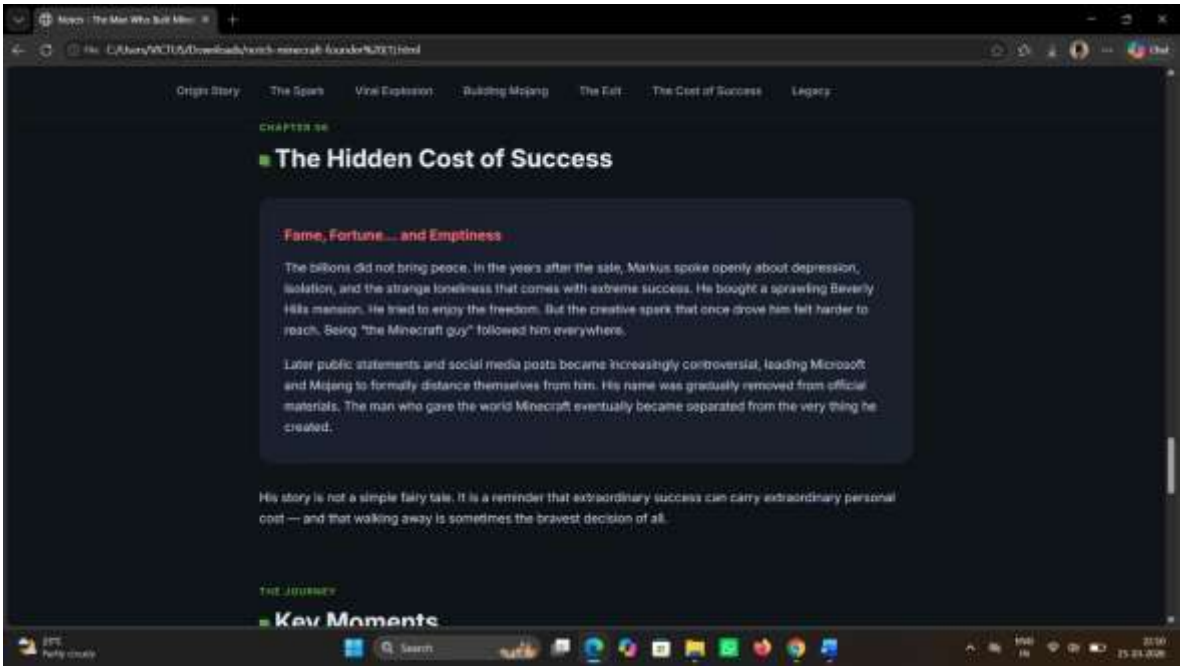


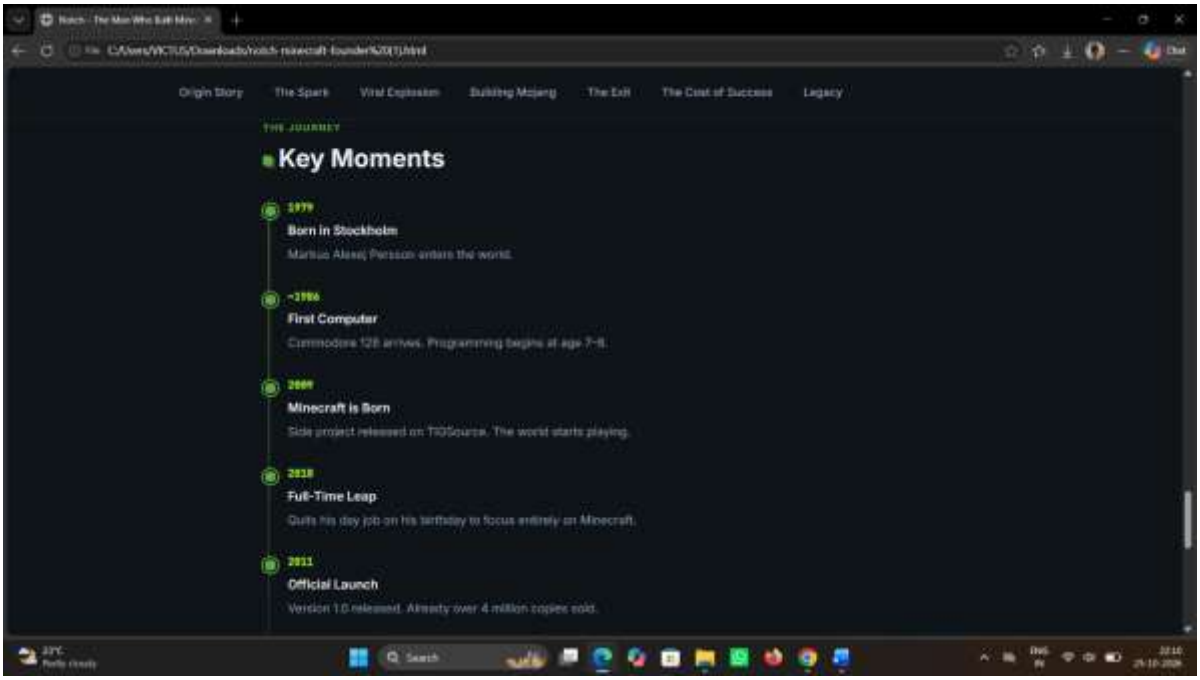
> *"I just wanted to make a game that could make enough money to make another game."*
>
> — Markus "Notch" Persson

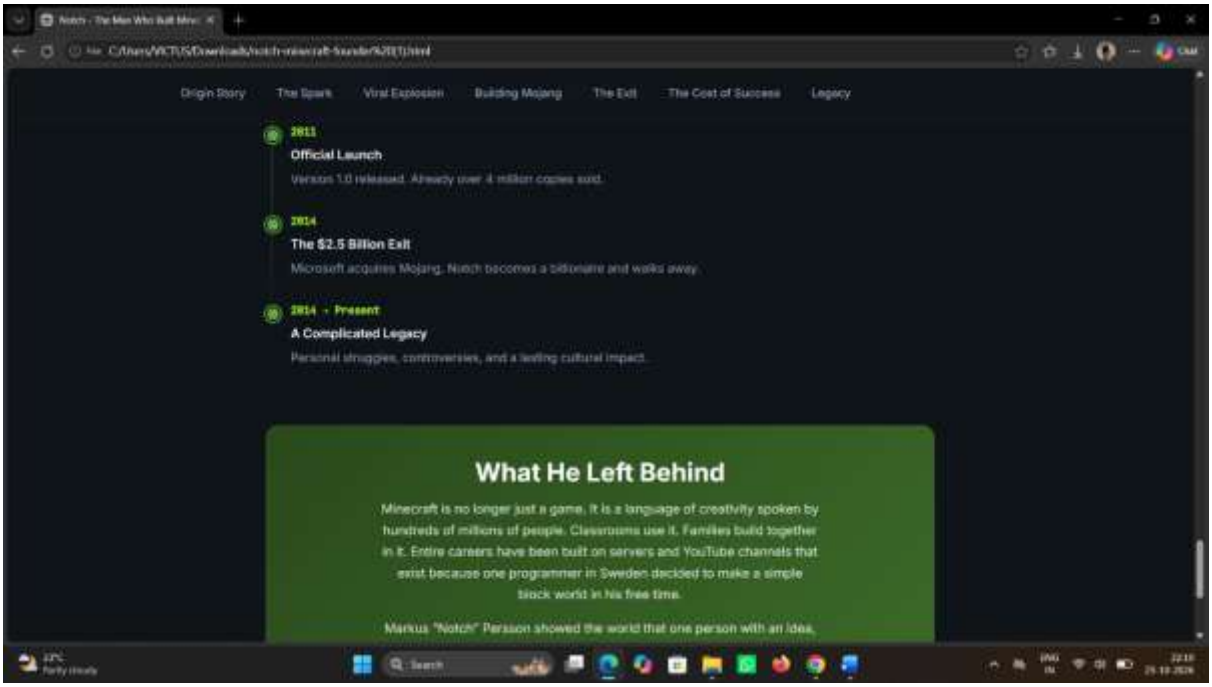

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The Viral Explosion
Players didn't just download Minecraft — they lived in it. They built castles, survived the night, shared secrets on forums, and created their own rules. Because there were almost no instructions, the community became the teacher.
Sales started slow: 40 copies in the first weekend. Then the numbers began climbing. Within months Markus could reduce his day-job hours. On his birthday in June 2010 he quit entirely to work on Minecraft full-time. By the time the official 1.0 version launched in November 2011, the game had already sold over four million copies.
40
4M+
$0
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Building Mojang
To support the growing phenomenon, Markus founded Mojang (Swedish for "thingamajig" or "gadget"). The

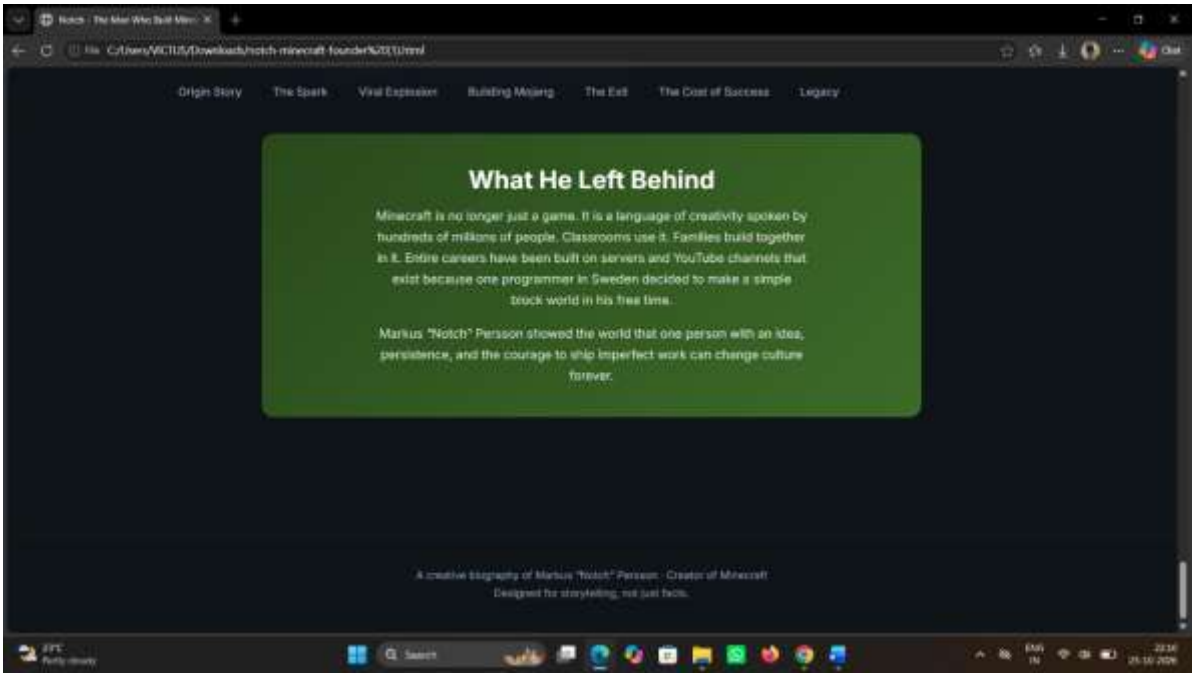

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studio stayed surprisingly small for years — often under 40 people — while generating tens and then hundreds of millions in revenue. He brought in talented collaborators, most notably Jens Bergensten, who eventually took over as lead designer so Markus could step back from the daily pressure of being the sole creative force.
Minecraft expanded to mobile, Xbox, and beyond. Merchandising deals appeared. Teachers started using it in classrooms. LEGO partnered with it. A generation of kids learned creativity, logic, and collaboration inside a blocky world that one man had built in his spare time.
What Made It Special
Complete creative freedom
No forced tutorial or goals
Players became co-creators
Worked on almost every platform
Community-driven evolution
Early Achievements
Best-selling game of all time
Time 100 Most Influential
Massive educational impact
Defined the sandbox genre
Proved indie games could win
Walking Away from a Kingdom


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Walking Away from a Kingdom
In September 2014, Markus publicly asked if anyone wanted to buy his share of Mojang so he could "move on with his life."
Microsoft answered. Three months later the deal was done: $2.5 billion in cash for Mojang and Minecraft. Markus held the majority stake. Overnight he became one of the wealthiest game developers in history. And just as suddenly, he walked away.
"It's not about the money. It's about my sanity. I've become a symbol. I don't want to be a symbol."
— Notch, explaining why he sold
He had built something so massive that it no longer felt like his. The pressure, the expectations, the constant attention — it had stopped being fun. Selling was not a cash grab. It was an escape.


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The Hidden Cost of Success
Fame, Fortune... and Emptiness
The billions did not bring peace. In the years after the sale, Markus spoke openly about depression, isolation, and the strange loneliness that comes with extreme success. He bought a sprawling Beverly Hills mansion. He tried to enjoy the freedom. But the creative spark that once drove him felt harder to reach. Being "the Minecraft guy" followed him everywhere.
Later public statements and social media posts became increasingly controversial, leading Microsoft and Mojang to formally distance themselves from him. His name was gradually removed from official materials. The man who gave the world Minecraft eventually became separated from the very thing he created.
His story is not a simple fairy tale. It is a reminder that extraordinary success can carry extraordinary personal cost — and that walking away is sometimes the bravest decision of all.
THE JOURNEY
Key Moments


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THE JOURNEY
Key Moments
1979
Born in Stockholm
Markus Alexej Persson enters the world.
~1986
First Computer
Commodore 128 arrives. Programming begins at age 7–8.
2009
Minecraft is Born
Side project released on TIGSource. The world starts playing.
2010
Full-Time Leap
Quits his day job on his birthday to focus entirely on Minecraft.
2011
Official Launch
Version 1.0 released. Already over 4 million copies sold.


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2011
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2014
The $2.5 Billion Exit
Microsoft acquires Mojang. Notch becomes a billionaire and walks away.
2014 – Present
A Complicated Legacy
Personal struggles, controversies, and a lasting cultural impact.
What He Left Behind
Minecraft is no longer just a game. It is a language of creativity spoken by hundreds of millions of people. Classrooms use it. Families build together in it. Entire careers have been built on servers and YouTube channels that exist because one programmer in Sweden decided to make a simple block world in his free time.
Markus "Notch" Persson showed the world that one person with an idea,


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Markus "Notch" Persson showed the world that one person with an idea, persistence, and the courage to ship imperfect work can change culture forever.
A creative biography of Markus "Notch" Persson - Creator of Minecraft
Designed for storytelling, not just facts.